

DIPLOMATIC WORKING DOCUMENT — AD REFERENDUM

The Muscat Framework

*An Interim Coordinated Transit and De-escalation Arrangement
for Regional Maritime and Nuclear Stabilization*

*"This Framework continues unless affirmatively concluded.
Inaction sustains the arrangement."*

Version 1.5 — Technical Negotiation Draft

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Executive Summary — Read This First

Four pages. The remainder are technical annexes for implementation staff.

The Problem

Direct negotiations have reached an impasse. Neither side can move first without appearing to capitulate. Both capitals require a pathway that delivers mutual stabilization without requiring either to surrender core sovereignty claims.

The Framework Solution

The United States and the Islamic Republic of Iran participate as Principal States through coordinated regional security mechanisms, with operational implementation channeled through neutral-facilitated arrangements. Two coordinating mechanisms manage the respective operational components:

- **MSCG** (Maritime Security Coordination Group) — coordinates the US-aligned operational elements
- **RSCC** (Regional Stability Coordination Cell) — coordinates the Iran-aligned operational elements

These entities leverage existing institutional channels and do not create new standing coalitions.

The De-Risking Principle

Operational incidents are addressed through a graduated response system rather than automatic escalation. This transforms what would traditionally trigger conflict into a manageable law-enforcement problem with a credible and proportionate escalation ladder.

The Backbone: Four Elements That Survive Any Disruption

Even if all other provisions are suspended, these elements continue for a minimum of 180 days:

1. **Ceasefire** — 72-hour auto-renewing arrangement (Omani-facilitated hotline; renews at Hour 71)
2. **Humanitarian corridor** — Zero-fee Hormuz transit for medicine, food, medical equipment
3. **60% enrichment freeze** — IAEA-verified within 72 hours

4. \$250M humanitarian tranche — Swiss escrow, non-reversible upon activation

What Each Side Achieves

Iran

Sovereign nuclear rights preserved under NPT Article IV. Relief secured through neutral channels. HEU custodied in Oman under IAEA dual-lock, not transferred to the United States. Binding non-regime-change assurance. Renewable arrangement, not permanent surrender.

United States

Weapons-grade uranium departs Iranian territory on Day 1. Enrichment capped at 3.67%. No new centrifuges. Every US measure matched by simultaneous verified Iranian measure. Proxy operational reductions substantially decrease regional attacks. Sanctions architecture remains officially intact.

Total pages to read: 4. The remainder are technical annexes for implementation staff.

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Part I: Core Agreement

Binding provisions. All Parties are obligated. All other provisions depend on these.

Section 1: Purpose and Scope

Article 1.1 — Purpose

This Framework establishes interim coordinated arrangements for regional maritime stabilization, nuclear risk reduction, and associated de-escalation measures between the United States of America and the Islamic Republic of Iran, implemented through neutral-facilitated channels and verified by international institutions.

Article 1.2 — Scope

This Framework addresses:

1. Removal of highly enriched uranium stockpile from active Iranian enrichment facilities to certified third-party custody
2. Maritime deconfliction in the Strait of Hormuz and associated waterways
3. Coordinated reduction in proxy operational activity affecting regional stability
4. Humanitarian trade facilitation and targeted economic measures
5. Verification and monitoring by international organizations

This Framework does not address permanent disposition of nuclear material, comprehensive sanctions removal, or bilateral diplomatic normalization. Those matters are reserved for subsequent negotiations, subject to the performance of this Framework.

Article 1.3 — Limitations

This Framework is an interim arrangement. It does not constitute a comprehensive peace settlement, mutual recognition instrument, or permanent treaty. It creates no obligation beyond its express terms and does not prejudice either Party's position on matters outside its scope.

All implementation timelines and technical specifications are subject to verification and may be adjusted through mutual agreement as operational experience is gained.

1.4 No Precedent Effect

Article 1.4 — No Precedent Effect

This Framework establishes no legal or political precedent for unrelated disputes. It is *sui generis*, tailored to the May 2026 operational environment. No inference may be drawn regarding proxy frameworks in other conflicts, maritime governance in other waterways, sanctions architecture for other jurisdictions, or bilateral diplomatic frameworks with other parties. This text shall not be cited in any international court or treaty proceeding to define or alter sovereign rights under international law elsewhere in the world.

Section 2: Legal Basis and Authority

Article 2.1 — Authority of the Parties

This Framework is entered into under existing executive and constitutional authorities:

For the United States: International Emergency Economic Powers Act (50 U.S.C. §1701 *et seq.*); executive orders regarding sanctions; the President's constitutional authority over foreign affairs and as Commander in Chief; and applicable statutory authorities for humanitarian assistance and arms control verification.

For the Islamic Republic of Iran: Authority of the Supreme National Security Council and the Presidency under the Constitution of the Islamic Republic of Iran; authority of the Atomic Energy Organization of Iran under applicable Iranian law; and the Government's treaty-making authority under the Iranian Constitution.

For Facilitating States: Each Facilitating State acts within its own domestic legal framework and international obligations. No Facilitating State assumes obligations beyond those expressly undertaken.

Article 2.2 — No New Legislation Required

This Framework does not require new legislation in any Party's jurisdiction. Implementation occurs through existing lawful authorities and executive instruments. Where implementing regulations are necessary, they shall be issued within 30 days of Framework activation where practicable.

Article 2.3 — Continuity Through Leadership Transition

Leadership transitions do not void obligations. This Framework binds the state, not the individual officeholder. Elections, cabinet reshuffles, or changes in senior personnel do not affect the validity or enforceability of any provision.

If domestic legal review identifies a material incompatibility with a Party's constitutional or statutory framework, the Emergency Judicial Pause (Article 9.2) applies without penalty. Judicial restraint does not constitute breach.

Article 2.4 — Sovereignty Preservation

This Framework does not supersede any constitution. It does not create supranational authority. The Treaty on the Non-Proliferation of Nuclear Rights is preserved. US treaty commitments to Gulf partners are preserved. Iranian sovereign title to all nuclear material remains intact regardless of custodial location. This Framework explicitly recognizes Iran's sovereign right to peaceful nuclear energy under NPT Article IV through monitored, non-weapon pathways.

Section 3: Core Principles

3.1 Synchronized Reciprocal Motion

Principle: Neither side acts alone. Every Iranian commitment is matched by a corresponding US commitment, activated simultaneously, verified by neutral observers. Unlike sequential models where one side moves first and trusts the other to follow, this Framework requires synchronized activation verified by third parties.

3.2 Narrative Accommodation

Article 3.2 — Narrative Accommodation

Each Party may publicly characterize this Framework in terms consistent with its domestic political requirements, provided such characterization does not materially misstate the Framework's provisions or the other Party's obligations.

The United States may describe this as a regional stabilization initiative led through allied coordination mechanisms with Iran following verified conditions. The Islamic Republic may describe this as a reciprocal de-escalation tool secured through neutral facilitation that preserves sovereign nuclear rights and avoids direct bilateral concession. Neither characterization constitutes a breach.

3.3 Mutual Respect in Public Characterization

Article 3.3 — Mutual Respect in Public Characterization

Parties shall refrain from public characterizations inconsistent with reciprocal implementation and the mutual dignity of sovereign states. This applies to all forms of official messaging, diplomatic communications, and statements to domestic or international media. Both Parties undertake to describe the Framework as a reciprocal stabilization instrument in which each side obtains commensurate benefits through neutral-facilitated channels.

3.4 No Regime Change Intent

Article 3.4 — No Regime Change Intent

This Framework shall not be interpreted as authorizing, supporting, or condoning forcible regime change, territorial fragmentation, unconstitutional political overthrow, covert destabilization operations, or economic strangulation designed to precipitate governmental collapse in either Party. Both Parties affirm that this instrument is confined to nuclear stabilization and maritime de-escalation and creates no license for broader political interference.

3.5 No Goalpost Moving

Article 3.5 — No Goalpost Moving

Neither party may unilaterally redefine compliance criteria, verification standards, or certification thresholds after they have been certified by the Joint Implementation Group. Completed milestones and already-released benefits remain in force regardless of subsequent compliance questions in other modules.

3.6 Modular Architecture with Partial Continuity

Article 3.6 — Partial Continuity Rule

Stabilization pause in one module does not suspend unrelated modules. Maritime disputes do not terminate humanitarian channels. Nuclear verification gaps do not affect Hormuz transit. The Partial Continuity Rule applies automatically; no governance body approval is required. When one module enters stabilization pause, all other modules continue at current operational levels for a minimum of 90 days while recovery options are assessed.

Table 1 Module Survival Tiers

Tier	Classification	Modules	Behavior During Pause
1	Inviolable	Ceasefire hotline; humanitarian access; emergency diplomatic channel	Never pause under any circumstances
2	Protected	IAEA basic monitoring; Hormuz non-military transit; initial asset releases	Continue during most stabilization pauses
3	Conditional	SWIFT reconnection; advanced tranches; successor talks; facility conversion phases	May enter hold during disputes

Section 4: Minimum Viable Configuration (Backbone)

Article 4 — The Backbone

The MVC is not a fallback. It is the structural backbone of this Framework. Four elements operate independently of all other provisions and survive total suspension for a minimum of 180 days:

Table 2 MVC Backbone Elements

#	Element	Specification	Duration
1	72-Hour Auto-Renewing Ceasefire	Omani-facilitated hotline. Renews at Hour 71 automatically. Neither party may disable without 30 days' notice to the UN Secretary-General.	Indefinite; renewable
2	Humanitarian Corridor	Zero-fee Hormuz transit for medicine, food, medical equipment. Legally non-divertible.	Indefinite; non-conditional
3	60% Enrichment Freeze	IAEA-verified within 72 hours of activation. All downstream benefits contingent on confirmation.	Pending successor agreement
4	\$250M Humanitarian Tranche	Swiss escrow to UN humanitarian mechanisms upon activation. Non-reversible.	One-time; immediate

Survival Guarantee: Even if all optional modules collapse, if both Principals formally withdraw, or if the Framework enters Tier 3 breach, the MVC continues for 180 days minimum. The ceasefire hotline and humanitarian corridor survive indefinitely as standalone humanitarian arrangements under UN auspices.

Section 5: Core Architecture

The United States and the Islamic Republic of Iran participate as Principal States. Operational implementation is channeled through two coordinating mechanisms and a neutral facilitation structure. No direct bilateral operational coordination is required between the Principals.

Table 3 Architecture Overview

Layer	Western Side	Iranian Side	Interface
Principal States	United States	Islamic Republic of Iran	No direct operational contact
Coordinating Mechanisms	MSCG	RSCC	Bilateral operational arrangements through neutral facilitation
Neutral Facilitation	Core Triad: Oman (maritime and physical custody), Switzerland (financial verification), IAEA (nuclear verification)		

5.1 The Maritime Security Coordination Group (MSCG)

The MSCG comprises the United Kingdom, specialized Gulf Cooperation Council task forces, Switzerland, and Oman. It acts as the operational coordinator for the US-aligned elements of this Framework. The MSCG is not a new standing coalition; it is an administrative coordination mechanism leveraging existing institutional channels: US CENTCOM, allied naval commands, and Omani maritime authorities. Its function is to coordinate de-escalation measures and monitor compliance on the US side.

5.2 The Regional Stability Coordination Cell (RSCC)

The RSCC coordinates the Iran-aligned operational elements of this Framework. It is not a new standing coalition; it is an administrative coordination mechanism leveraging existing institutional channels: Iranian naval command, established liaison protocols, and Omani relay channels. Its function is to coordinate stand-down measures and verify operational compliance on the Iranian side.

5.3 Graduated Incident Response

Article 5.3 — Graduated Incident Response

Operational incidents are addressed through a three-tier system:

Tier	Incident Type	Response	State-to-State Impact
1	Minor violation (single drone overflight, warning shot, reporting delay)	Coordinating mechanism resolves within 24 hours; no economic penalty	None — operational friction
2	Significant violation (vessel interdiction, mine-laying attempt, sustained proxy activity)	48-hour attribution by Joint Forensic Maritime Board; affected module pauses	Principal review convened; no military response
3	Major attack (vessel damaged or crew casualties; confirmed state-level weapons involvement)	Emergency consultation within 6 hours; economic penalties per Article 8; Reconstitution Conference within 30 days	Potential escalation; de-escalation remains priority

Attribution must be confirmed by the Joint Forensic Maritime Board before Tier 3 response. No automatic state-to-state escalation. The graduated response preserves stability while providing a credible escalation ladder.

5.4 Direct Principal Consultation (Emergency Channel)

Article 5.4 — Direct Principal Consultation

Under normal operations, all communications flow through coordinating mechanisms and the Core Triad. Either Principal may invoke direct consultation if:

- An incident causes significant military fatalities from a single state
- A confirmed state-to-state military strike occurs
- A nuclear facility is attacked
- Either Principal certifies an existential threat to the Framework

Upon invocation: proxy channels continue; the Principal-to-Principal hotline (Omani-facilitated) becomes the primary channel; all MVC elements continue unconditionally; the Core Triad convenes within 6 hours; a 72-hour cooling-off period activates with no automatic military response. Reversion to standard channels occurs within 30 days of crisis resolution unless both Principals agree otherwise.

5.5 Proxy Coordination Parameters

Article 5.5 — Proxy Coordination Parameters

Coordination, Not Governance: The Core Triad and coordinating mechanisms facilitate implementation. They do not govern. All significant decisions remain with the Principals. Facilitators verify, report, and mediate. They do not direct, override, or substitute for sovereign decision-making.

No Proxy Autonomy: Coordinating mechanism members have no independent authority to declare breach, suspend benefits, modify timelines, or communicate directly with the other Principal's coordinating mechanism. All significant decisions are made by the Principals through the Core Triad.

Proxy Commitments Are Principal Commitments (via Relay): When this Framework references commitments by operational partners, the mechanism is: the Principal transmits written orders through established relay channels, provides the Secretariat with proof of transmission, and compliance is verified through the Joint Forensic Maritime Board.

5.6 Proxy Universe Freeze

Article 5.6 — Proxy Universe Freeze

(a) **Initial Designations:** The operational partner universe is limited to groups explicitly listed in Annex E (Classified) at signature.

(b) **No New Designations:** Neither party may add new groups to its coordinating mechanism after signature without unanimous consent of the Core Triad and 30 days' written notice to the other Principal.

(c) **Removal:** Either party may unilaterally remove a group from its own coordinating mechanism by written notice to the Secretariat. Removal is effective immediately.

(d) **Unlisted Group Protocol:** If a group not listed in Annex E commits an attack, it is not attributable to either Principal unless the Joint Forensic Maritime Board finds clear evidence of command, control, or material support. Default: non-attributable, referred to appropriate law enforcement or security mechanisms.

(e) **Annex E Review:** Annex E is reviewed every 24 months. Additions require mutual consent. No additions within the first 12 months of Framework operation.

Section 6: Core Exchange — Day-One Reciprocal Arrangement

The Core Exchange is the synchronized, concurrent activation of all commitments on Day 1. Neither Principal acts alone. All actions are verified by neutral observers.

Table 4 Day-One Reciprocal Exchange

Principal	Commitment	Verification
Iran	60% HEU stockpile consolidated and placed in IAEA custody for transfer to Oman	IAEA DG confirmation; mass spectrometry; chain-of-custody documentation
	Freeze all enrichment at or above 60% at Natanz and Fordow	IAEA continuous monitoring; real-time data to Vienna and Geneva
	Operational pause: reduction in proxy activity affecting US positions and regional stability	CENTCOM assessment; regional security forum reporting
	IRGC-Navy craft withdraw from Hormuz transit corridor to stand-off positions	AIS broadcast; satellite confirmation; Omani naval observer
United States	USD 250 million humanitarian tranche via Swiss escrow	Swiss escrow agent certification; irrevocable transaction
	OFAC general license for humanitarian trade (medicine, food, medical equipment, aviation safety) for 90 days	Federal Register publication; Swiss confirmation
	US naval forces transition to stand-off posture: no patrols within 5nm of Hormuz transit corridor	AIS broadcast; daily satellite confirmation; Omani observer
	Written commitment: no new sanctions designations for Framework duration	Secretariat records; 14-day monitoring

6.1 Verification and the Stabilization Gate

Article 6.1 — The Stabilization Gate

Both moves activate within a 72-hour window. By Day 14, three primary verification channels must certify completion:

- 1. **Nuclear Verification (IAEA):** All 60% HEU cylinders consolidated, sealed, and in transit or arrived at custody facility
- 2. **Maritime Observation (Oman):** US vessels at stand-off posture, Iranian craft withdrawn, zero interdiction incidents Days 1–14
- 3. **Financial Confirmation (Switzerland):** USD 250M credited, transaction settled, OFAC license issued and in force

If any primary channel has not issued certification by Day 14, the Secretariat convenes a 48-hour Operational Consultation. Late certification is accepted without penalty. Non-certification after 72 hours triggers investigation, but Day-One commitments survive regardless.

Verification timelines and technical specifications are subject to operational conditions and may be adjusted through mutual agreement as implementation experience is gained.

6.2 Prohibition on US Custody

Article 6.2 — Prohibition on US Custody of Iranian Nuclear Material

Under no circumstances may Iranian enriched uranium be transferred to US territory, custody, or control. The Oman Nuclear Custody Facility is the sole designated location for Iranian HEU stockpile under IAEA dual-lock custody. All disposition pathways specify third-party destinations. No pathway terminates in US jurisdiction. This provision is binding and non-negotiable.

Section 7: The Core Triad

Day-to-day oversight is consolidated into three entities. The Core Triad provides facilitation, verification, and coordination support. It does not govern. All significant decisions remain with the Principals.

Table 5 The Core Triad

Entity	Domain	Core Function
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Oman	Maritime + Physical Custody	Hotline management, naval deconfliction, HEU physical custody, Joint Forensic Maritime Board hosting
Switzerland	Financial Verification	Escrow administration, asset transfer verification, sanctions relief monitoring
IAEA	Nuclear Verification	Enrichment monitoring, facility inspection, chain-of-custody certification

7.1 Triad Decision-Making

Article 7.1 — Triad Decision-Making

The Core Triad operates by consensus where practicable. Where consensus cannot be reached within 72 hours, the matter is referred to the Joint Coordination Secretariat in Geneva for facilitated resolution. In cases of irreconcilable disagreement, the Principals are consulted through standard channels.

No Triad member may unilaterally suspend, modify, or override any Framework provision. Triad members provide verification support and operational coordination. Final authority rests with the Principals.

7.2 Emergency Arbitration

Article 7.2 — Expedited Dispute Resolution

For time-sensitive disputes requiring rapid resolution:

- **Maritime disputes:** Oman provides binding ruling within 48 hours, subject to subsequent Principal review
- **Financial disputes:** Switzerland provides binding ruling within 48 hours, subject to subsequent Principal review
- **Nuclear disputes:** IAEA Director General provides technical determination within 72 hours; political disputes referred to Principals

Either Principal may override an arbitration ruling within 14 days by invoking Direct Principal Consultation (Article 5.4). Override does not constitute breach but suspends the disputed measure pending resolution.

7.3 Joint Forensic Maritime Board

Article 7.3 — Joint Forensic Maritime Board

- (a) **Exclusive Jurisdiction:** The Board has sole, binding authority to attribute maritime incidents to a specific party or operational partner.
- (b) **Composition:** Two forensic experts (one US-nominated, one Iran-nominated), two independent experts (Omani and Swiss), one signals specialist (neutral, rotating), one maritime law expert (ITLOS-appointed), one UN observer (non-voting).
- (c) **Binding Timeline:** Preliminary finding within 48 hours; final attribution within 96 hours. No attribution = no breach classification.
- (d) **No Unilateral Attribution:** No Principal or state may declare an attack involves weapons supplied by the other without Board certification.
- (e) **False Flag Protection:** If the Board determines an incident was a false flag, a 72-hour cooling-off period activates. Neither Principal may escalate during investigation.

Section 8: Graduated Response Framework

The Framework employs a graduated breach architecture that prevents minor violations from triggering catastrophic collapse. The system applies equally to Principal and coordinating mechanism actions.

Table 6 Three-Tier Response Architecture

Tier	Trigger	Response	Surviving Rights
Tier 1: Technical	Single data anomaly; reporting delay under 48h; minor operational incident	14-day remediation continues. Enhanced inspection; daily reporting until cleared. No relief suspension.	All relief continues. All constraints remain. Humanitarian channel uninterrupted.
Tier 2: Material	Confirmed enrichment above 3.67%; unauthorized UF6 diversion; sustained proxy activity; serious Hormuz incident	Discretionary suspended; escrow; remediation; reporting	relief Humanitarian channel continues. Enrichment freeze survives. IAEA access active. 60-day cap survives. Ceasefire active.

Tier 3:	Weaponization activity	Full rollback; posture	Humanitarian corridor continues
Hostile	confirmed by IAEA and two independent sources; sustained non-compliance after Tier 2; state-level military attack	returns to pre-Day 1; under UN mandate. NPT Reconstitution safeguards remain. Ceasefire Conference within 30 days	hotline resumes. Custodial stockpile remains under IAEA control.

8.1 Attribution Rules

Article 8.1 — Attribution Rules for Operational Partner Actions

When a coordinating mechanism member commits an act that would constitute a breach if attributed to a Principal:

- Level 1 (State Command):** Clear evidence the Principal ordered the act → treated as Principal breach at corresponding tier
- Level 2 (State Knowledge):** Evidence the Principal knew and failed to prevent → Tier 1 or 2 depending on severity
- Level 3 (Independent Actor):** No evidence of Principal knowledge or involvement → internal matter for the respective coordinating mechanism; does not trigger Principal breach unless pattern persists 30+ days
- Level 4 (False Flag):** Evidence the act was committed by a third party to frame a Principal → cooling-off period activates; investigation period 72 hours

8.2 Earn-Back Protocol

Article 8.2 — Earn-Back Protocol

A Party correcting a Tier 1 or Tier 2 issue may petition for earn-back. The Secretariat convenes within 14 days. If IAEA confirms 60 days of sustained compliance post-correction, suspended benefits restore progressively: 25% at 30 days, 50% at 60 days, 75% at 90 days, 100% at 120 days. Compliance scoring resets upon full restoration.

8.3 Framework Survival Core

Article 8.3 — Framework Survival Core

Under all circumstances, including total Framework suspension, three elements survive:

1. **Ceasefire Hotline:** Omani-facilitated 24/7 bilateral hotline remains active regardless of Framework status. Neither party may disable without 30 days notice to the UN Secretary-General.
2. **Humanitarian Access:** Zero-fee Hormuz humanitarian corridor continues regardless of any dispute, breach, or suspension.
3. **Emergency Channel:** Backchannel through the Coordination Secretariat remains open for crisis communication regardless of formal diplomatic status.

The Survival Core is established as a standalone humanitarian arrangement under UN auspices. It continues for 180 days even if both parties formally withdraw.

Section 9: Political Shock Absorber

9.1 Automatic Review Pause

Article 9.1 — Automatic Review Pause

If any of the following occur in either party's jurisdiction, Framework implementation automatically enters a **Review Pause**:

- National elections or referenda
- Leadership transition or assassination
- Cabinet collapse or reshuffle affecting negotiating ministries
- Mass protests affecting government authority
- Significant military incident affecting domestic politics

During Review Pause: all MVC elements continue; Tier 3 modules enter hold; Secretariat issues certificate within 48 hours; maximum duration 90 days, extendable by mutual agreement. Review Pause does not constitute breach and does not trigger the three-tier response system.

9.2 Emergency Judicial Pause

Article 9.2 — Emergency Judicial Pause

If a domestic court issues a restraining order affecting implementation: the MVC continues unconditionally; all parties enter Review Mode; no penalties accrue during judicial review; if restraint persists beyond 45 days, the affected party may invoke Force Majeure Stabilization Mode without penalty. Judicial restraint does not constitute breach.

9.3 Presumptive Continuation with Biennial Affirmative Vote

Article 9.3 — Presumptive Continuation

- (a) **Default State: Continuation.** This Framework continues indefinitely unless terminated through affirmative opt-out.
- (b) **Biennial Vote.** Every 24 months, each party conducts a domestic vote on continuation (US: both Congressional chambers; Iran: Majlis). Simple majority required. Failure to hold a vote, abstention, or absence constitutes a vote for continuation.
- (c) **Opt-Out.** To terminate, a party must secure an affirmative majority against continuation. If either party votes to terminate, a 90-day Cooling-Off Period activates before termination takes effect.
- (d) **Reversal.** The terminating party may reverse its opt-out at any time during the Cooling-Off Period, with full continuity restored.
- (e) **Binding Effect.** If the legislature votes for continuation, the executive may not override or refuse to implement Framework obligations.

9.4 Cooling-Off Period

Article 9.4 — Cooling-Off Period

If either party's legislature votes to terminate: termination does not take effect for 90 days; all MVC elements continue; the Core Triad convenes emergency consultations within 14 days; the terminating party may reverse at any time before expiry; if the Cooling-Off Period expires without reversal, withdrawal proceeds under sequenced deactivation over 90 additional days. Total window for reconstitution or reversal: 180 days.

Section 10: Rollback Architecture and Earn-Back

This Framework replaces "snapback" with graduated rollback preserving more than it removes.

Rollback Principles

- **Proportionality:** Response matches severity
- **Graduation:** Each tier preserves more than it removes
- **Reversibility:** Suspended benefits are earn-backable through verified compliance
- **Protected Milestones:** Completed milestones and released benefits remain in force
- **No Goalpost Moving:** Neither party may redefine compliance criteria after certification

10.1 Sequenced Deactivation

Article 10.1 — Sequenced Deactivation

If a party withdraws or the Framework terminates, deactivation occurs in reverse order over 90 days:

1. **Days 1–30:** Tier 3 modules (conditional) pause. Tier 1 and 2 continue.
2. **Days 31–60:** Tier 2 modules (protected) wind down. MVC continues.
3. **Days 61–90:** Tier 1 modules (inviolable) continue until MVC 180-day minimum expires.
4. **Day 90+:** Full deactivation except Survival Core elements.

No party may accelerate deactivation unilaterally. The sequenced approach preserves stability during the transition period and provides time for reconstitution efforts.

Section 11: Communications and Crisis Protocols

11.1 Approved Terminology

Both Parties agree to employ terminology consistent with the Framework's reciprocal character:

Table 7 Approved Terminology

Avoid	US Characterization	Iranian Characterization
"Nuclear deal"	"Regional stability mechanism"	"Sovereignty-protecting de-escalation tool"

"Sanctions relief"	"Humanitarian facilitation"	trade	"Economic normalization through neutral channels"
"Uranium transfer"	"Weapons-grade material secured"	material	"Custodial transfer to IAEA/Omani partners"
"Proxy disarmament"	"Regional security integration"		"Axis of Regional Stability formalization"
"Hormuz tolls"	"Environmental protection levy"		"Sovereign maritime environmental fee"

11.2 Crisis Communications

Crisis response protocols are detailed in Annex D. Core principles:

- **Unauthorized Leak:** No official comment on draft documents; 4-hour initial response
- **Contradictory Statement:** Senior official clarification attributed to Secretariat; 24 hours
- **Misinformation:** Pre-approved fact sheets; key channels briefed; 6 hours
- **Inflammatory Statement:** No official response; backchannel through Omani Foreign Minister; 72-hour cooling period
- **Operational Partner Incident:** Principal notes "operational friction"; neutral facilitators investigate; 12 hours
- **External Attack:** Political Shock Absorber activates; Review Pause; emergency Secretariat session; 6 hours

Section 12: Instruments of Acceptance

Article 12.1 — Entry into Force

This Framework is offered for acceptance by exchange of instruments through the Designated Facilitating States, or by exchange of diplomatic notes confirming intent to be bound. It enters into force upon the later of the two acceptances, for an initial period of twelve months, renewable through the biennial affirmative vote procedure (Article 9.3). Non-renewal does not constitute breach and does not retroactively invalidate obligations performed during operation.

Article 12.2 — Authentication

The original shall be deposited with the Secretary-General of the United Nations, who shall transmit certified copies to both Parties and all Designated Facilitating States. The Framework shall be authenticated in the English and Persian languages, both texts being equally authentic.

Article 12.3 — Amendment

Amendments require mutual written consent of both Principals and certification by the Core Triad. Technical modifications to annexes may be approved by the Joint Coordination Secretariat where both Principals raise no objection within 14 days.

For the United States of America:

Name: _____

Title: _____

Date: _____

Witnessed by the Sultanate of Oman
(Facilitating State — Maritime):

Name: _____

Title: _____

Date: _____

Witnessed by the State of Qatar
(Facilitating State — Liquidity):

Name: _____

Title: _____

Date: _____

For the Islamic Republic of Iran:

Name: _____

Title: _____

Date: _____

Witnessed by the Swiss Confederation
(Facilitating State — Financial):

Name: _____

Title: _____

Date: _____

**Witnessed by the International Atomic
Energy Agency**
(Nuclear Verification Authority):

Name: _____

Title: _____

Date: _____

Part II: Optional Modules

Opt-in provisions. Activated by mutual consent. May operate independently.

Module A: Maritime De-escalation and Hormuz Transit

Module A.1 — Maritime Freedom Arrangement

Regional maritime authorities coordinate a localized Red Sea and Gulf of Aden Maritime Freedom Arrangement under which:

1. Regional maritime authorities formally announce a moratorium on commercial vessel targeting in designated waters
2. The Omani Maritime Trust collects a synchronized "Regional Environmental and Safety Tariff" from commercial shipping
3. This tariff is routed to a third-party logistical escrow administered by Switzerland
4. US Navy maintains presence but transitions to stand-off posture (no patrols within 5nm of transit corridor)
5. Iranian naval small craft withdraw from the central transit corridor

Detailed tariff schedules and operational protocols are provided in Annex B.

Module A.2 — International Hormuz Transit Council

A new International Hormuz Transit Council (IHTC) is established as the multilateral oversight body, with membership: Iran, Oman, UAE, Switzerland (observer), UK (observer), IAEA Maritime (technical). The IHTC sets transit rules, tariff rates (which may not exceed agreed ceilings without consensus), and dispute procedures. Neither the US nor Iran has unilateral veto; a supermajority (4 of 6 voting members) is required for rule changes.

Face-saving: Iran retains its national maritime authority as a sovereign institution. The US achieves multilateral oversight preventing unilateral chokehold. Both sides claim governance of Hormuz.

Module B: Nuclear Safeguards and Custody Arrangements

Module B.1 — Technical Storage via Oman

The Atomic Energy Organization of Iran signs a technical storage agreement with the Sultanate of Oman. Omani personnel take custody of sealed HEU canisters for movement to a secure facility under IAEA oversight. Simultaneously, Switzerland opens a mirrored humanitarian credit facility. Sovereign title to all nuclear material remains with Iran; the transfer is custodial, not proprietary. Iranian observer teams accompany every stage.

Detailed custody chain procedures are provided in Annex A.

Module B.2 — The Fordow Medical Isotope Joint Venture

The Fordow facility is converted to the International Medical Isotope Research Center (IMIRC) through a scientific joint venture led by Switzerland, Oman, WHO, and IAEA. All enrichment at Fordow ceases; the facility is repurposed for medical isotope production under full IAEA safeguards. International funding of \$175M+ is provided through the joint venture. Iran maintains sovereign ownership; international partners provide operational oversight.

Module C: Regional Security Coordination

Module C.1 — Regional Security Forum

The United Kingdom and the Government of Iraq host a Regional Security Forum in Baghdad. At this forum, localized operational partners sign border-security stabilization arrangements committing to enforcement of buffer zones along critical commercial lines. If an unauthorized operation occurs, it is treated as a local incident enforced through the Forum's internal coordination. The Coordination Secretariat's Crisis Response Cell investigates attribution.

Module C.2 — Drone-Free Buffer Zones

Designated zones restrict armed UAV operations in transit corridors and border regions. Enforcement is through Omani naval radar, regional monitoring, and coordinating mechanism internal protocols. Violations are addressed through the graduated response system (Article 5.3).

Detailed zone coordinates and enforcement protocols are provided in Annex B.

Module D: Economic Reconnection

Module D.1 — Primary Financial Channel

All financial flows go through the Swiss Financial Cell. The Swiss escrow is protected by a formal Presidential Policy Directive prohibiting unilateral re-freezing except in Tier 3 breach. If Swiss escrow encounters operational difficulty, UAE/Omani private banking syndicates may activate as backup channels with automated compliance screening and distributed transaction monitoring.

Module D.2 — Staged Asset Release

Asset releases occur in stages, triggered by verified milestones. All releases are non-reversible once executed.

Detailed release matrices are provided in Annex C.

Face-saving: Washington maintains that sanctions remain in place officially; the coordinating banks handle humanitarian exemptions and third-country trade. Tehran receives funds through established channels without formally accepting expanded financial surveillance.

Module E: Parallel Public Framework (Dual-Track)

Module E.1 — Optional Activation

Within 30 days of Framework signature, both Principals may agree in writing to activate the Parallel Public Framework. Activation requires mutual consent.

Module E.2 — Public Framework Content

If activated, a separate public document is issued simultaneously in Washington and Tehran describing the same commitments using direct state-to-state language ("Iran commits," "US commits"). It does not mention coordinating mechanisms or operational implementation channels. It is framed as a "Synchronized Stabilization Understanding."

Module E.3 — Deniability Preserved

The operational document remains classified. Public statements refer only to the public framework. The two documents are legally separate but factually identical. Either party may withdraw from the Parallel Public Framework with 30 days' notice; withdrawal does not affect the operational framework.

Part III: Technical Annexes

Operational detail for implementation staff. Not required for political sign-off.

Annex A: Nuclear Escrow — Custody Chain

Technical detail for IAEA, Omani, and Iranian implementation teams

Annex Table A1 Custody Chain of the Omani-Swiss Escrow

Phase	Period	Action	Verifying Party
Activation	Day 1 (72-hour window)	Framework activates; IAEA inspectors arrive at Esfahan	Joint Coordination Secretariat
Inventory	Days 1–7	Physical inventory; mass spectrometry confirms isotopic composition; cylinders loaded into casks; tamper-evident seals applied	IAEA
Transit	Days 7–14	Convoy departs under IAEA escort; GPS tracking activated	IAEA + Omani Navy
Receipt	By Day 14	Casks unsealed in presence of IAEA, Omani facility director, and Iranian AEOI observer	Three Primary Channels
Custody	Day 14+	IAEA assumes operational custody; Custody Transfer Certificate triggers Tranche 3 release	IAEA + Omani Military

A.1 HEU Disposition Pathways

Annex Table A2 Post-Escrow HEU Disposition Pathways

Pathway	Description	Timeframe
Downblending	Convert 60% to 19.75% LEU for research reactor fuel; remainder to 3.67%	18–24 months
Third-Country Custody	Extended custody in Oman or transfer to another agreed third party	12-month renewable
Medical Production	Isotope Transfer to IMIRC at Fordow for Mo-99/Tc-99m production	Subject to JV timeline
Export Downblending	for Transfer to Russia, France, or UK for commercial downblending	By mutual consent
Storage Under IAEA	Continued IAEA storage pending comprehensive agreement	Indefinite; renewable
Blend for Fabrication	Fuel Blend with depleted uranium for LWR fuel elements	24+ months

Note: All pathways specify third-party destinations. No pathway terminates in US jurisdiction (Article 6.2).

Annex B: Maritime Buffer Zone Specifications

Technical detail for naval operations and monitoring teams

Annex Table B1 Buffer Zone Specifications

Zone	Coordinates	Restriction	Enforcement	Violation
Hormuz Transit Corridor	26°N, 56°E (central channel)	No armed UAVs; no loitering drones	Omani naval radar + IHTC monitoring	Tier 1; 48-hour remediation
GCC Border Regions	Iraq-Kuwait, Iraq-Saudi borders	No cross-border drone transit	Regional internal policing + UK technical assistance	Tier 1; Security Forum convenes
Red Sea Commercial Lane	Bab-el-Mandeb to Suez	No vessel-targeting UAVs	Moratorium + coalition patrol	Tier 2 if attributed
Israel-Lebanon Buffer	Blue Line 10km	No offensive drone operations	UNIFIL enhanced commitment	+ Tier 2; cooling-off activates

B.1 Environmental Transit Tariff Schedule

Annex Table B2 Transit Tariff Schedule

Vessel Type	Tariff	Collection Method
Oil tankers (>50,000 DWT)	\$0.10 per barrel of cargo	Automated via AIS + cargo declaration
Container vessels	\$500 per transit	Pre-paid through Maritime Council portal
General cargo / bulk carriers	\$250 per transit	Pre-paid through Maritime Council portal
WFP / humanitarian vessels	\$0 (exempt)	Automated exemption via UN registration
Military / naval vessels	\$0 (exempt)	Flag state declaration

Annex C: Financial Release Matrices

Technical detail for Swiss escrow and banking implementation teams

Annex Table C1 Staged Asset Release Schedule

Stage	Timing	Amount	Trigger
Micro-Pilot	Day 1	\$250M	Framework signature
Stage 1	Day 14	\$750M	HEU in Omani custody
Stage 2	Day 45	\$1.5B	Moratorium ratified

Stage 3	Day 180	\$5B	Full compliance
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C.1 Progressive Milestones (Stage 3 Detail)

Annex Table C2 Progressive Milestone Releases

Milestone	Timing	Deliverable	Release
Tranche 3	Day 60	IAEA confirms freeze sustained	\$1.5B; insurance facility access
Tranche 4 SWIFT	/ Day 90	IAEA confirms zero new centrifuges	SWIFT for compliant banks
Tranche 5	Day 120	Transit Authority operational	\$3B; expanded authorizations
Tranche 6	Day 150	Six-month clean certification	Banking normalization Tier 1
Tranche 7	Day 180	Full compliance; successor talks opened	\$5B; 85% assets; tech transfer
Year 1 Clean	Day 365	Additional Protocol ratified	\$10B total; normalization pathway

Annex D: Crisis Communications Protocols

Technical detail for communications and media teams

Annex Table D1 Crisis Response Matrix

Crisis Type	Trigger	Response Protocol	Time
Unauthorized Leak	Confidential text published	"We do not comment on draft documents" statement; internal investigation	4 hours
Contradictory Statement	Official Framework publicly contradicts	Senior official issues clarification; attribution to Secretariat	24 hours
Viral Misinformation	False claims spread rapidly	Pre-approved fact sheets; key channels briefed; corrections posted	6 hours
Inflammatory Speech	Senior politician attacks Framework	No official response; backchannel through Omani Foreign Minister; cooling period	72 hours
Operational Partner Incident	Coordinating mechanism member breaches	Principal notes "operational friction"; neutral facilitators investigate	12 hours
External Attack	Third-party strikes during implementation	Shock Absorber activates; Review Pause; emergency session	6 hours

D.1 Joint Coordination Secretariat Structure

Annex Table D2 Secretariat Subcells

Subcell	Function	Location
Political Coordination	Senior bilateral coordination; dispute resolution; proxy liaison	Geneva
Maritime Operations	Hormuz transit; naval deconfliction; hotline; IHTC support	Muscat
Nuclear Verification	IAEA coordination; enrichment monitoring; inspection logistics	Geneva
Financial Operations	Escrow; asset transfer verification; SWIFT coordination	Geneva
Communications	Media coordination; public messaging; narrative framing	Geneva
Crisis Response	24/7 incident monitoring; attribution; rapid response	Muscat (primary) / Geneva (backup)

D.2 Emergency Contacts

Function	Contact	Location
Emergency Hotline	Omani Maritime Operations Cell	Muscat, Oman
Nuclear Verification	IAEA Forward Team Alpha	Muscat, Oman — 24/7
Financial Emergency	Swiss Financial Cell	Geneva, Switzerland
Diplomatic Crisis	Omani Foreign Ministry	Muscat, Oman
Secretariat General	Joint Coordination Secretariat	Geneva, Switzerland
Crisis Response Cell	24/7 Duty Officer	Muscat / Geneva

Annex E: Classified Implementation Provisions

Restricted distribution. Authorized negotiators and implementation staff only.

E.1 Proxy Universe Designations (Annex E)

Classification Notice

The specific designations of operational partners within the MSCG and RSCC coordinating mechanisms are contained in a separately classified Annex E document. This annex is not included in the public or general distribution versions of this Framework.

Access to Annex E is restricted to: Principal negotiators; Core Triad leadership; Joint Coordination Secretariat senior staff; and designated implementation commanders.

E.2 Public/Classified Two-Layer Structure

Annex Table E1 Information Classification Matrix

Information Category	Public Framework	Technical Draft	Classified Annex E
Framework principles and MVC	Yes	Yes	Yes
Core Triad structure	Yes (simplified)	Yes	Yes
Financial release triggers	No	Yes (summary)	Yes (detailed)
Custody chain procedures	No	Yes (summary)	Yes (full technical)
Named operational partners	No	No	Yes
Drone zone coordinates	No	Yes (general)	Yes (precise)
Communication protocols	No	Yes	Yes (secure channels)
Attribution threshold evidence	No	No	Yes

E.3 Key v1.5 Protection Summary

Structural protections in this Framework: Graduated tiered response (Article 5.3) | No US Custody (Article 6.2) | No Goalpost Moving (Article 3.5) | No Precedent firewall (Article 1.4) | Emergency Judicial Pause (Article 9.2) | Proxy Universe Freeze (Article 5.6) | JFM Board sole attribution (Article 7.3) | Direct Principal Consultation (Article 5.4) | Parallel Public Framework (Module E) | Biennial continuation vote (Article 9.3) | Cooling-Off Period (Article 9.4) | MVC 180-day survival (Article 4) | Earn-Back Protocol (Article 8.2) | Framework Survival Core (Article 8.3) | Legal Basis and Authority (Section 2)

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